

# MANIMALA CHITHAMANAN

## Policy Researcher & Political Analyst — Tamil Nadu Governance

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### PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Policy researcher and practitioner with a proven track record in bridging the gap between state-level strategic planning and last-mile execution. Experienced in managing complex, multi-stakeholder government programs across 37,000+ units. Currently an IMPRI Data Analytics Fellow (2026), leveraging a multi-disciplinary toolkit — from historical context to quantitative modeling in R and Stata — to analyze structural economic transformations, the platform economy, and federal equity.

### PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

#### IMPRI Data Analytics for Policy Research Fellow (2026)

**Impact and Policy Research Institute | Policy Analytics & Quantitative Methods** Mar 2026 – Jun 2026 • Remote, Delhi

- Quantitative Modeling: Applying statistical methods to evaluate socio-economic datasets, specifically focusing on State-Level Planning metrics and fiscal indicators.
- Technical Toolkit: Developing proficiency in Stata and R for econometric analysis, data cleaning, and visualization of large-scale government surveys (PLFS, NFHS).
- Policy Synthesis: Training in translating complex quantitative outputs into actionable Policy Briefs for non-technical stakeholders.

#### Policy & Partnerships Consultant

**Namma School Namma Ooru Palli | Government of Tamil Nadu**

May 2024 – Aug 2025 • Chennai

- Contributed to state-level strategic planning by synthesizing partnership data from 30+ CSR entities to align private investment with public education priorities.
- Optimized resource distribution workflows for 37,000+ school units, serving as a feedback loop for state-level planners to identify infrastructure gaps.
- Bridged the operational vacuum between state-level planning and district-level execution by fostering direct relationships with District Education Officers (DEOs).
- Produced structured briefings used by senior bureaucrats for infrastructure gap identification and resource allocation decisions.

#### Research Associate

**Apogee Research Forum**

Jan 2024 – Apr 2024 • Chennai

- Co-developed a governance performance framework evaluating 30+ Tamil Nadu MPs on parliamentary records, attendance, and constituency metrics.
- Compiled and analysed quantitative data from government sources, parliamentary records, and constituency-level metrics.
- Coordinated TN Youth Parliament event engaging 15 colleges across Chennai.

#### Research Intern

**Foundation for Democratic Reforms & Global Madras**

Sep 2023 – Mar 2024 • Hyderabad & Chennai

- Conducted policy research on democratic reforms, governance frameworks, and international relations.
- Authored research summaries and contributed to internal policy notes on institutional strengthening.

### WRITING & POLITICAL RESEARCH

- manimalachithamanan.in** — Independent Tamil Nadu Governance Desk: political analysis covering fiscal federalism, Tamil Nadu elections, the platform economy, and legislative accountability.
- "When the Algorithm Beat the Alliance"** — Analysis of TVK's digital campaign infrastructure, DMK's governance narrative gap, and Tamil Nadu's political future (2026).

- **Legislative Intelligence** — Performance reports and data dashboards on 39 Tamil Nadu Lok Sabha MPs (18th Lok Sabha); tracking attendance, questions, debates, and bills.
- Policy briefs and structured reports produced for Government of Tamil Nadu state-level planners.

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**EDUCATION**

**Master of Arts (MA) — Politics & International Relations** 2021 – 2023  
*Central University of Gujarat*

**Bachelor of Arts (BA) — History & Tourism** 2018 – 2021  
*Stella Maris College, Chennai*

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**SKILLS & COMPETENCIES**

**Policy Research & Strategy:** Evidence-informed policy synthesis, governance research, strategic reporting, and legislative performance tracking. Expert in translating complex socio-political contexts into actionable policy commentary.

**Operational Governance & M&E::** Large-scale program management (37,000+ units), Results-Based Management (RBM) frameworks (UNICEF certified), multi-level stakeholder coordination (Government, CSR, NGOs), and SOP design for state-wide initiatives.

**Data Analytics & Econometrics:** Microsoft Excel (Advanced: Dashboards, VLOOKUP, Pivot Tables), basic Power BI. Currently building advanced quantitative capabilities in R, Stata, and Python for econometric modeling and impact evaluation.

**Research Methodologies:** Proficient in both qualitative field research and quantitative secondary data analysis (NFHS, PLFS for state-level planning).

**Languages:** Tamil (Native), English (Professional)